THE RESTLESS FOUNDER / FREE GUIDE

The Family Stack

How to build things that compound across generations, and use AI to stop resetting the clock.

For anyone building something their children can stand on.

Compounding only works if you keep what you build.

Most families start again every generation. The knowledge, the contacts, the lessons, the business, all of it lives in one person's head and leaves with them.

Stacking is the opposite. Each generation hands the next one something finished: a business with written systems, relationships that are kept warm, stories that are told, and a few simple rules that explain how the family decides things. The next person does not start at zero. They start on top.

Resetting

Everything lives in one head. Lessons are learned the hard way, again. Distance quietly ends the relationships.

Stacking

What you learn gets written down, passed on and built on. Distance is managed on purpose.

The hard part was always the writing down. It is slow, and nobody has the time. That is exactly the job AI is good at: you talk, it organises. This guide gives you four layers to stack, and the prompts to capture each one.

You do not need your parents to have done this for you. You only need to start it for the ones after you.

Four things worth stacking.

Pick the one that matters most to you this month. You do not need all four at once.

01 KNOW-HOW	**What you have learned.** How you built what you built, what failed, what you would do differently. The things that took you years and could take your children one afternoon.
02 BUSINESS	**What you run.** The systems, the suppliers, the decisions. If you stepped away for a month, could someone else keep it alive from a written page?
03 PEOPLE	**Who you keep close.** Grandparents, cousins, mentors, old friends. Relationships fade without a rhythm, and distance makes that faster.
04 STORY	**Where you come from.** The journeys, the sacrifices, the sayings. A child who knows the story knows what they are standing on.

One layer, thirty minutes, this week. That is the whole start.

Capture it out loud.

Talk, do not type. Record a voice note on your phone, or sit with an older relative and let them talk. Then give the transcript to an AI and ask it to organise, not to invent.

1 THE INTERVIEW

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I am going to interview someone in my family about their life and
what they learned. Ask me one question at a time, starting with: what
did you wish someone had told you at my age? Follow up on anything
that sounds like a lesson or a story. After ten questions, stop and
wait.
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2 THE FAMILY LESSONS

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Here is the transcript: (paste it here). Pull out the ten most useful
lessons in their own words, each in one or two sentences. Then pick
the three best stories and write each as a short paragraph a child
could read. Do not add anything that was not said. Mark anything
unclear with a question.
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3 MY OWN LESSONS

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Interview me about my work and my life. I want to leave my children
what I wish I had been given. Ask me, one at a time, about the three
biggest mistakes I made, the three best decisions, and the rules I
now live by. Then write them up in my voice, plainly.
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Keep the original recordings. The recording of a grandparent's voice is worth more than any summary of it.

Make it survive without you.

4 THE HANDOVER PAGE

I run (describe your business). Interview me, one question at a time, until you can write a one-page handover: what the business does, how money comes in, the five recurring jobs and how each is done, who the key contacts are, and the three decisions only I make. Do not include passwords. Write it so a capable stranger could keep the business running for a month.

5 THE PEOPLE LIST

Here are the people who matter in my family and my work: (names and one line on each). For each, suggest one small way to stay in touch that takes under ten minutes and suits the distance between us, and a rhythm: weekly, monthly or twice a year. Put it in a simple table.

If you live far from home

Distance is a decision, not a fate. Put the rhythm in the calendar the way you would a meeting: a weekly call with the grandparents, a voice note on a Friday, a visit planned before the year starts. Let the children be on the call, even for two minutes. What is kept warm stays alive.

Safety note: keep logins, bank details and private documents out of any AI tool. Describe the process, never the secret.

Thirty minutes, once a month.

1 **Add one thing to one layer.** One interview, one handover page, one story. Never more.

2 **Run the review prompt below.** It tells you which layer you have been ignoring.

3 **Book the next call or visit** with someone you are keeping close.

6 THE MONTHLY REVIEW

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Here is what I added to my family stack this month: (list it). Here
are the four layers: know-how, business, people, story. Tell me which
layer is thinnest, suggest one thirty-minute task for it next month,
and tell me one thing I have already captured that my children would
be glad to have. Keep it under 120 words.
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A year of this is twelve small deposits. Ten years is a library your family did not have before, written by the person who was actually there.

An approach to adapt, not financial, legal or tax advice. For anything involving wills, inheritance or company ownership, speak to a qualified professional.

You may not have been handed a stack. You can still be the one who starts it.